



The morning papers reported the birth, of course, but their headlines were also full of scary warnings of a nationwide “general strike.” The shutdown began on May 3, 1926, halting trains and buses, and bringing mines and factories to a standstill.

On May 29, baby Elizabeth Alexandra Mary was christened in the chapel at Buckingham Palace. The baby wore the same lace gown made for Queen Victoria’s children, and was baptized at a font filled with water from the River Jordan (the river in which Jesus was baptized, according to the Bible). Baby Elizabeth cried the whole time.

